PPS Screen Time Policy Update



PORTLAND
Public Schools

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Learning Target and Success Criteria

I am learning about the alignment of the proposed School Beyond Screens Technology Use policy draft and the PPS Healthy Technology Use policy draft.

I can describe what is aligned between the two proposals and opportunities for additional alignment.

Thank You!

The PPS Digital Ecosystem Parent Advisory Committee has met on:

- August 18
- October 19

We are meeting once per quarter.

Members: PPS Office of Technology and Office of Academics representation, Schools Beyond Screens Parent Leadership Team

<u>Results to Date:</u>

- Common vision and objectives
- Agreement of majority of key points



Why is this work important?

Establishes clear, research-backed boundaries for technology use to safeguard students' physical, social-emotional and cognitive development.

Prioritizes teacher-led instruction and hands over learning and fosters equitable classrooms where all students can build critical thinking skills.

Ensures technology enhances learning.

Protects student data privacy.

Technology Use for PK-12 Classrooms Guidance Key Principles

Human-Centered Learning Comes First	Technology must never replace authentic relationships between educators, students, and peers, humans should be in the driver's seat when using technology.
Purposeful and Research-Based Adoption	Technology should only be integrated when it demonstrably enhances learning, engagement, and instructional quality.
Equity and Access for All Learners	Every student should have equitable access to the same technologies and tools, instruction, and literacy, ensuring all students are prepared to thrive and lead in an increasingly technology-driven world.
Ethical Use and Informed Practice	Implement technology effectively through establishing clear policies for safe and ethical use and provide sustained professional learning for educators, staff, and students.
Continuous Evaluation, Future Readiness, and Community Partnership	The use of technology in education should be regularly assessed to ensure it advances learning outcomes, centers equitable practices, and addresses sustainability and safety.
Future-Ready Learning and Workforce Preparation	Technology integration can be beneficial if it supports students in developing the durable skills, knowledge, adaptability, and ethical grounding they need to succeed in the careers and civic life of the future.

Shift from Screen Time to Screen Value

Quality Matters More than Quantity

- EdTech built in accordance with how people learn offer distinct advantages for academic learning (e.g., Feng, 2025; Hillmayr et al., 2020).
- Poorly built educational technology adds unnecessary cognitive load, thus inhibiting learning and academic performance (Støle et al., 2020).

EdTech is Particularly Impactful for Underserved Students

- Students with disabilities, multilingual learners, and students performing below grade proficiency often show disproportionately large gains from well-designed tools.
- For these students, technology is not simply a supplement to learning but an essential means of access, opportunity, and participation (Di Pietro & Castaño Muñoz, 2025; Lee et al., 2022; McKissick et al., 2018).

Shift from Screen Time to Screen Value

Consumer Tech Is Not EdTech

- EdTech, built by learning designers, operates from different incentives, learning strategies, and desired outcomes than commercial platforms engineered for intensive engagement.
- Research on social media or other consumer/entertainment tools does not necessarily apply to educational tools (American Academy of Pediatrics, 2025).

Implementation Drives Effectiveness

- Alongside product quality, implementation factors (e.g., Kohler et al., 2022) significantly affect how edtech influences student learning.
- Factors such as teacher preparation, curriculum alignment, and learning setting all affect how well any given product helps students learn (Bernard, 2018; Nordmark et al., 2024; Wu, 2024).
- As with any educational program or intervention, implementation must fit the local context.

SBS & PPS Policy Comparison Overview

Level 4: Strong Agreement Identical or Nearly identical policy language	Level 3: Agreement, Needs Fine Tuning High Consens with minor thresholds or numeric variations	Level 2: Agreement, Gaps to Close Shared Intent requiring operational reconciliation	Level 1: Needs Work to Align Direct policy friction or missing provisions
(28%) Hardware, Ads, IEPs, and Digital Literacy	(50%) Gamification, Grades PK-2, Grades 3-5, Grades 6-8, High School, Paper Priority, Audits	(7%) Generative AI	(14%) Parental Consent & Opt-out

SBS & PPS Policy Full Agreement

- K-8 Hardware & Distribution
- Commercial Ads & Filtering
- IEP, 504 and Personal Education Plans (PEP) exceptions.
- Digital Literacy Curriculum
- Screen Time Guiding Principles
- Adherence to FERPA and other regulations

SBS & PPS Policy - Fine Tuning Needed

Policy Domain	Alignment Level & Summary Rationale	PPS Screen Time Policy Proposal	Schools Beyond Screens Policy Proposal
Grade 6-8 Screen Limits	Consensus on subject caps (45 min/wk) with minor variation in total weekly ceiling (300 vs 315 min).	Up to 45 min/subject/wk, max 300 min/wk total across all classes (except tech-critical courses).	Max 45 min/subject/wk, max 315 min/wk total across all classes.
High School Screen Limits	Exact agreement on weekly caps (60 min/subj, 480 total) and lunch restrictions.	Up to 60 min/subject/wk, max 480 min/wk total (except tech-critical/CTE courses); screen-free lunch.	Max 60 min/subject/wk, max 480 min/wk total; computer use during lunch restricted to study halls.

SBS & PPS Policy - Fine Tuning Needed

Policy Domain	Alignment Level & Summary Rationale	PPS Screen Time Policy Proposal	Schools Beyond Screens Policy Proposal
Use of Print Materials	Both prioritize paper-based learning; SBS codifies paper as policy default.	Paper materials provided for reading, writing, and math; offline paper homework offered whenever possible. Allows for word processing and other tools such as presentation tools.	Paper materials mandated as default for reading, writing, and math; paper format required for homework.
Technology Audit & Tool Removal	Identical audit scope and 90-day decommissioning of rule for non-compliant tools.	Annual audit of all digital apps/tools contracts with Technology Advisory Committee and 90-day removal rule.	Annual audit of digital tools by an auditor with Technology Advisory Committee and 90-day removal rule.

SBS & PPS Policy - Fine Tuning Needed

Policy Domain	Alignment Level & Summary Rationale	PPS Screen Time Policy Proposal	Schools Beyond Screens Policy Proposal
Gamified Learning & Using Technology as Rewards	Both identify the need to not use technology as rewards. SBS states need to turn off all gamified learning in any adopted curriculum.	Identifies not to use technology as a reward. Use of leaderboards and badges with in vetted, approved adopted curriculum.	Identifies not to use technology as a reward. Turn off all leaderboards and badges in any digital applications.
PreK - 2 Screen Limits	Shared goal to restrict early screen exposure, but PPS establishes weekly classroom caps while SBS enforces 0 min routine use. Both have exceptions for state requirements at all grade levels.	Screen-free PK. K: up to 45 min/wk; Grade 1: up to 60 min/wk; Grade 2: up to 90 min/wk.	Screen-free K–2 (0 min/wk routine use); max 90 min assessment prep.

SBS & PPS Policy - Gaps to Close

Policy Domain	Alignment Level & Summary Rationale	PPS Screen Time Policy Proposal	Schools Beyond Screens Policy Proposal
Grades 3-5 Screen Limits	Both restrict elementary screen time, but PPS cap is (225 min/wk) and the SBS ceiling is (100 min/wk).	Up to 225 minutes per week inclusive of core instruction and intervention.	Maximum twenty (20) minutes per day, not to exceed 100 minutes per week
Generative AI & LLM Tools	PPS makes specific mention of chatbots. SBS mandates a formal Board moratorium while PPS uses standard app vetting.	PPS removed all language about GenAI because the policy committee wants a separate AI policy	Absolute moratorium on student-facing AI on district devices until Board AI policy & curriculum are adopted.

SBS & PPS Policy - Needs Work to Align

Policy Domain	Alignment Level & Summary Rationale	PPS Screen Time Policy Proposal	Schools Beyond Screens Policy Proposal
Parent Consent & Opt-out	PPS provides annual notification and information, whereas SBS guarantees active annual informed consent and explicit opt-out rights.	Parents receive annual information regarding EdTech use and privacy policies. PPS requires implementation of the process required by Oregon Law (OAR 581-021-0009) for curriculum opt-outs.	Annual informed consent required; guarantees unconditional parental right to opt out with paper accommodations.

Key Updates

- Alignment with Policy Committee for a separate AI Policy
- Removed Guiding Principles, Citations, and added Definitions
- Formated for a Board Policy
- Incorporated language to align with updated ODE guidance



Questions

